City of Northfield
PEOPLE PLACES POSSIBILITIES

Rachel S. Bailey, M.U.P.
Planning • Community Development • Communications

South Gateway & Riverside Neighborhood Revitalization Plan

A MORE CONNECTED, VIBRANT AND EQUITABLE NORTHFIELD





Complete Streets | Parks & Open Space | Vibrant Neighborhoods | Inclusive Communities | Economic Opportunity



STRONGER NEIGHBORHOODS



CONNECTED RIVERFRONT



A MORE EQUITABLE NORTHFIELD

Prepared by:

Rachel S. Bailey, M.U.P.
Rochester, NY
rootzy36@gmail.com

April 15, 2026
Submitted in Response to
RFP # 2026-PLN-07

PLANNING FOR PEOPLE | DESIGNING OPPORTUNITY | BUILDING A STRONGER TOMORROW

PROJECT UNDERSTANDING & REVITALIZATION APPROACH

Our approach treats South Gateway & Riverside as one connected district rather than a series of isolated sites. The planning process will combine existing-conditions and GIS analysis, community and stakeholder input, market and housing research, mobility analysis, and implementation testing to turn the opportunities shown below into coordinated, fundable actions. Each focus area has a distinct role, but together they support stronger neighborhoods, safer connections, river access, local business activity, housing choice, and long-term reinvestment.



Illustrative conceptual overlay - fictional South Gateway & Riverside study area.

SOUTH GATEWAY

Reposition the gateway as a welcoming mixed-use entry to the district. We will test infill housing, neighborhood-serving retail and services, public-realm upgrades, safer crossings, wayfinding, and development patterns that create a stronger transition between established neighborhoods, the corridor, and the riverfront.

MIXED-USE CORRIDOR

Strengthen the corridor as the district's everyday commercial spine. Recommendations will address storefront and facade reinforcement, upper-floor and infill housing, walkability, transit access, parking and curb management, streetscape improvements, and opportunities for locally owned businesses to benefit from reinvestment.

RIVERFRONT

Make the river a visible and accessible community asset. The plan will evaluate public access points, open-space and recreation connections, wayfinding, environmental constraints, resilience considerations, and development edges that face and activate the waterfront while protecting public access.

ESTABLISHED NEIGHBORHOODS

Protect neighborhood stability while expanding opportunity. Strategies will emphasize housing rehabilitation, context-sensitive infill, safer pedestrian connections, access to parks and services, and anti-displacement considerations so existing residents can share in the benefits of public and private investment.

CATALYST REDEVELOPMENT

Use the catalyst site to demonstrate what coordinated redevelopment can achieve. We will test feasible mixed-use concepts, housing and employment-generating uses, public-space relationships, access and circulation, development phasing, and potential public-private tools that can move a high-impact site from concept toward implementation.

TRAIL / PARK CONNECTION

Create a continuous low-stress connection linking neighborhoods, downtown destinations, open space, and the river. The concept will examine trail alignment, crossings, ADA accessibility, bicycle and pedestrian safety, landscaping, lighting, wayfinding, and connections to the broader street and park network.

Cover Letter

October 30, 2026
Procurement Office
City of Northfield, New York

Re: RFP No. 2026-PLN-07 - South Gateway & Riverside Neighborhood Revitalization Plan

Dear Evaluation Committee:

Bailey Planning + Community Development is pleased to submit this proposal to prepare the South Gateway & Riverside Neighborhood Revitalization Plan. We understand that Northfield is seeking more than a policy document: the City needs a community-supported investment framework that connects land use, housing, mobility, economic development, environmental conditions, public space, zoning, funding and implementation.

Our revised 16-month work program creates adequate time for rigorous analysis, sustained community engagement, catalyst-site testing, zoning recommendations, grant-readiness work and public review. The assignment will be led by Rachel S. Bailey, M.U.P., supported by illustrative specialist subconsultants in engagement, GIS/data, transportation and urban design.

Our proposed not-to-exceed fee is $319,400, including reimbursable expenses, within the City's $325,000 maximum. The scope, schedule and fee have been reconciled so that the proposal directly responds to all nine RFP tasks and provides the City with implementable, visually compelling and funding-oriented deliverables.

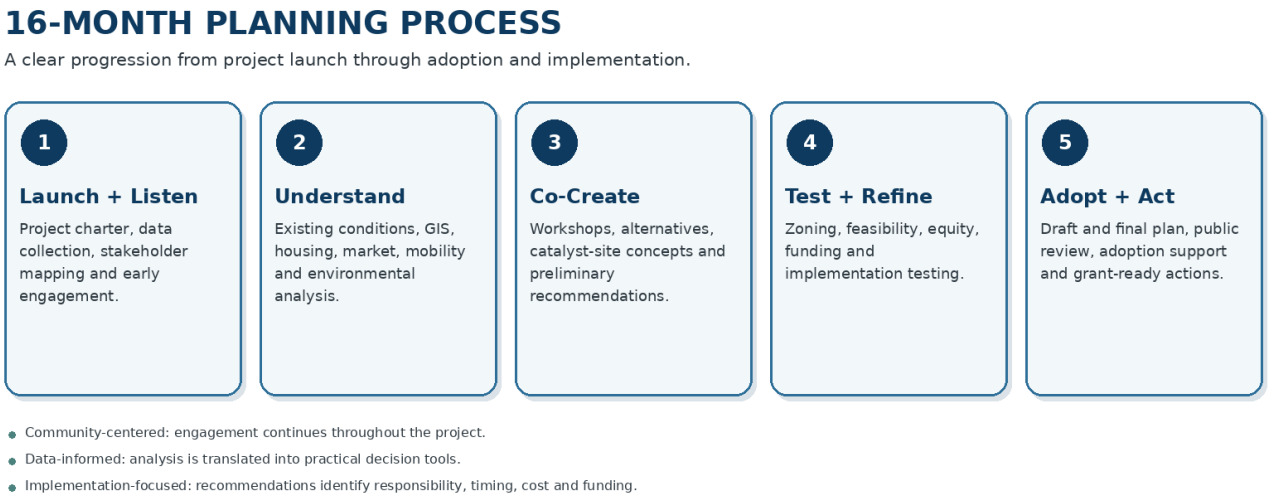
Sincerely,
Rachel S. Bailey, M.U.P.
Project Manager / Lead Planner
Bailey Planning + Community Development

Proposal Contents

Section	Content
1	Executive Summary
2	Project Understanding
3	Technical Approach & Scope
4	Community Engagement
5	Visual Planning & Catalyst Concepts
6	Schedule
7	Project Team
8	Project Manager Resume
9	Relevant Experience
10	Cost Proposal
11	Compliance Matrix
12	Appendix - Illustrative Deliverables

1. Executive Summary

South Gateway and Riverside present a connected set of challenges and opportunities: vacant and underutilized land, legacy industrial and commercial properties, housing affordability pressures, transportation barriers, environmental concerns, and a riverfront that can become a stronger neighborhood asset. Our approach moves from listening and evidence to concepts, testing, implementation and action.



- Community-centered - engagement is continuous and traceable from input to plan response.
- Data-informed - GIS, demographic, housing, market, transportation and environmental findings are translated into decision tools.
- Design-literate - priority sites and corridors are illustrated with concept plans, sections and before/after visualizations.
- Equity-conscious - affordability, displacement risk, accessibility and environmental justice are tested throughout.
- Implementation-focused - recommendations identify lead entities, partners, timing, preliminary costs, funding sources and measurable next steps.

Schedule: 16 months, January 2027-April 2028. **Fee:** $319,400 not-to-exceed.

2. Project Understanding

The South Gateway and Riverside study area is envisioned as a transition zone between established neighborhoods, commercial and former industrial land, community institutions, transportation infrastructure and the river. The central planning challenge is to ensure that reinvestment improves everyday life for existing residents while creating room for new housing, businesses, public space and safer connections.



Illustrative aerial context - South Gateway & Riverside study area (fictional portfolio rendering).

SOUTH GATEWAY & RIVERSIDE - ILLUSTRATIVE EXISTING SITE CONDITIONS

Conceptual study areas shown with realistic site imagery for this fictional portfolio project.



1 Riverside Gateway

Underutilized gateway parcel with potential for mixed-use infill, public space and stronger pedestrian connections to the river.



2 Downtown Corridor

Historic commercial corridor with local businesses, facade-improvement potential, infill opportunities and streetscape needs.



3 Riverfront Access

Existing river access with potential for expanded recreation, trail connections and improved wayfinding.



4 Rail-Trail Connection

Former rail corridor that could expand non-motorized transportation options and connect neighborhoods to downtown and the riverfront.



5 Adaptive Reuse Site

Vacant industrial property with potential for adaptive reuse, employment, neighborhood-serving uses and complementary development.



6 Neighborhood Stabilization

Residential area with opportunities for housing rehabilitation, sensitive infill and stronger connections to community amenities.

Illustrative portfolio imagery - Northfield is fictional; images are concept visuals, not documented existing conditions.

Planning Questions We Will Resolve

- Where can public investment unlock the greatest neighborhood benefit?
- Which vacant, obsolete or underutilized properties are realistic candidates for infill, adaptive reuse or mixed-use redevelopment?
- How can new mixed-income housing be paired with preservation and anti-displacement tools?
- How should Complete Streets, transit, trails, pedestrian crossings and river access function as one connectivity network?
- What zoning changes are necessary to enable the desired pattern while protecting neighborhood character?
- Which projects can be made grant-ready within the planning process?

3. Technical Approach & Scope of Work

Task 1 - Project Initiation & Management

Kickoff, project charter, detailed schedule, data request, stakeholder map, decision protocols, biweekly project management meetings, monthly progress reports, risk/action log, and quality-control procedures.

Deliverables: Project Management Plan; detailed schedule; data inventory; meeting summaries; monthly progress reports.

Task 2 - Existing Conditions, GIS & Field Analysis

Parcel, land use, zoning, demographic, housing, transportation, environmental, infrastructure, public-realm and community-asset analysis; field reconnaissance and photographic inventory; opportunities/constraints synthesis.

Deliverables: Existing Conditions Report; GIS geodatabase and map series; photo inventory; Opportunities & Constraints Map; presentation.

Task 3 - Community & Stakeholder Engagement

Inclusive engagement program with at least four public meetings/open houses, four neighborhood workshops, 20-25 stakeholder interviews, two business roundtables, youth/family engagement, advisory committee meetings, online/paper survey and pop-up outreach.

Deliverables: Engagement Plan; materials; survey/interview findings; meeting summaries; engagement database; final Engagement Summary.

3. Technical Approach & Scope - Continued

The remaining work program carries the project from technical analysis through implementation and adoption. Each task produces a defined decision tool or deliverable that feeds directly into the next phase.

4 Market, Housing & Development Opportunity Analysis

Housing needs and affordability; tenure/vacancy; commercial and development trends; displacement risk; priority-site screening; concept-level redevelopment scenarios and feasibility considerations.

DELIVERABLES

Housing & Development Opportunity Analysis; priority-site inventory; catalyst-site concepts; opportunity maps.

5 Transportation, Mobility & Connectivity

Pedestrian, bicycle, transit, vehicular, parking, ADA and safety review; river/trail access; Complete Streets opportunities; priority intersection and corridor concepts.

DELIVERABLES

Transportation Conditions Assessment; connectivity network; Complete Streets recommendations; priority project concepts.

6 Community Vision, Urban Design & Revitalization Framework

Synthesize analysis and engagement into a place-based framework covering land use, housing, economic development, mobility, public realm, open space, resilience, neighborhood identity and catalytic investment.

DELIVERABLES

Vision statement; revitalization framework; illustrative concept plans/sections; before-after visualizations; priority recommendations.

7 Zoning & Land Use Recommendations

Diagnostic of existing zoning and development standards; identify map/text amendments, mixed-use opportunities, adaptive reuse, parking reforms, design standards and affordability tools.

DELIVERABLES

Zoning assessment; recommended map/text amendments; implementation sequence.

8 Implementation, Funding & Grant Readiness

Implementation matrix with priority, lead entity, partners, timeframe, preliminary cost, dependencies, metrics and funding; five-year action plan; identify and outline at least three grant-ready projects.

DELIVERABLES

Implementation Matrix; Funding Strategy; Five-Year Action Plan; three grant-ready project sheets.

9 Draft Plan, Adoption Support & Final Deliverables

Prepare draft and final plan; executive summary; public presentation; staff/board briefings; comment matrix; final accessible files and editable source materials.

DELIVERABLES

Draft Plan; comment matrix; Final Plan; Executive Summary; presentations; GIS; graphics; editable source files.

4. Community Engagement Approach

Engagement will be integrated throughout the 16-month process rather than treated as a single event. The approach combines broad public participation with targeted conversations so residents, businesses, youth, property owners, service providers and implementation partners can influence both the vision and the practical action plan.

Community Engagement Framework

Multiple ways to participate, with a visible feedback loop from input to action.

Public Meetings

4 citywide touchpoints

Neighborhood Workshops

4 smaller-area sessions

Stakeholder Interviews

20-25 interviews

Business Roundtables

2 corridor sessions

Youth + Family Engagement

2 partner-based activities

Pop-Ups + Survey

At least 4 pop-ups + survey

Advisory Committee

6 milestone meetings

Draft Plan Open House

Recommendations + priorities

Engagement Element	Planned Level	Primary Role
Advisory Committee	6 milestone meetings	Guide milestones and connect technical/community priorities
Public Meetings / Open Houses	4	Share findings, test alternatives and review recommendations
Neighborhood Workshops	4	Focus on place-specific needs, opportunities and tradeoffs
Stakeholder Interviews	20-25	Capture detailed resident, institutional and implementation perspectives
Business Roundtables	2	Address corridor conditions, business needs and reinvestment
Youth / Family Activities	2 partner-based events	Reach participants less likely to attend formal meetings
Pop-Ups	At least 4	Meet people where they already gather
Survey	Online + paper	Broaden participation; multilingual as needed

Feedback Loop & Documentation

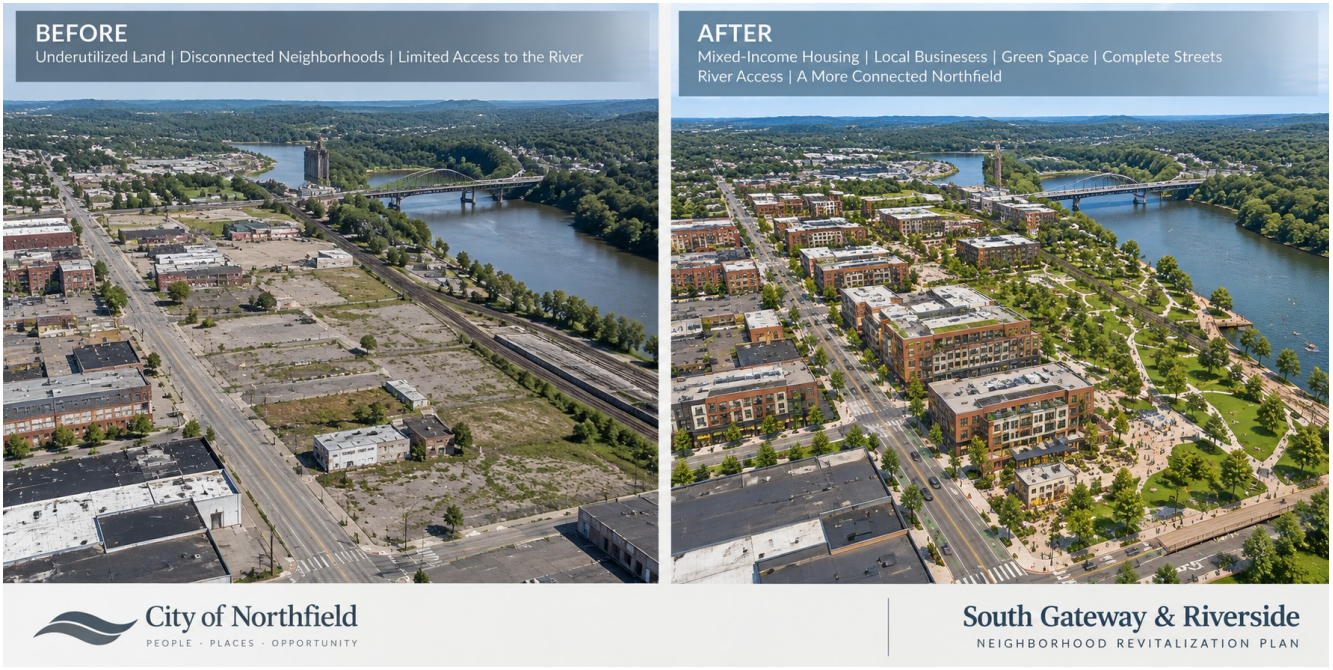
Each engagement round will be documented and summarized for the City. The team will show how community input influenced alternatives and recommendations, identify issues requiring additional technical review, and carry unresolved questions forward to the next milestone. This creates a transparent record from listening through adoption and helps residents see where their participation shaped the plan.

NEXT STEP: Translate engagement and technical findings into visual alternatives and catalyst concepts.

5. Visual Planning & Catalyst Concepts



Illustrative concept - riverfront greenway, accessible connections, gathering space and landscape improvements.



Illustrative Before/After Concept: underutilized land and disconnected river access transformed through mixed-income housing, local business space, green space, Complete Streets and stronger river connections. This image is conceptual and does not depict an actual Northfield site.

Illustrative Catalyst Project Sheets



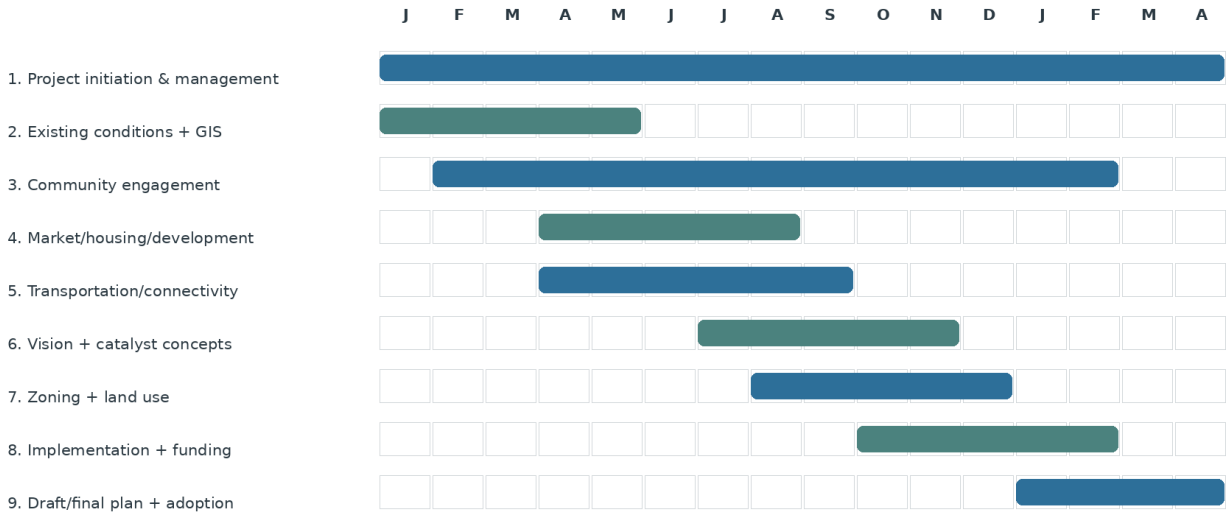
Illustrative concept - Riverside connection emphasizing trail continuity, safer multimodal access and riverfront identity.

Catalyst	Concept	Potential Implementation Tools
South Gateway Mixed-Use Infill	Mixed-income housing over neighborhood-serving commercial space; improved streetscape and transit access.	LIHTC/affordable housing programs; CDBG; HOME; private debt/equity; zoning incentives.
Riverside Greenway & Access	Continuous riverfront trail, accessible crossings, park improvements, stormwater landscapes and neighborhood connections.	Transportation grants; parks/open-space funds; climate/resilience grants; capital program.
Adaptive Reuse / Maker-Commercial Hub	Reuse of legacy building for small business, maker, community-serving and flexible employment space.	Brownfield programs; economic development grants; historic credits where eligible; local incentives.

6. Project Schedule

The revised 16-month schedule is intentionally longer than the earlier 12-month concept. The added time supports deeper engagement, stronger catalyst-site work, grant-readiness, zoning analysis and a meaningful public review/adoption period.

PROJECT SCHEDULE | JANUARY 2027 - APRIL 2028



Period	Major Activities / Milestones
Jan-Feb 2027	Kickoff, project charter, data transfer, advisory committee, stakeholder mapping
Mar-May 2027	Existing conditions, GIS, field work, interviews, survey, Public Meeting 1
Jun-Aug 2027	Housing/market/development and transportation analysis; workshops; business/youth engagement
Sep-Oct 2027	Priority sites, alternatives, catalyst concepts, Public Meeting 2
Nov-Dec 2027	Revitalization framework; urban design; zoning diagnostic; Public Meeting 3
Jan-Feb 2028	Implementation matrix, funding strategy, grant-ready project sheets
Mar 2028	Draft plan, open house/Public Meeting 4, City/board review
Apr 2028	Final plan, executive summary, adoption support, GIS/graphics/editable files

7. Project Team

Team Member	Role	Primary Responsibility
Rachel S. Bailey, M.U.P.	Project Manager / Lead Planner	Overall management; land use; housing/community development; technical writing; implementation; client coordination
Illustrative Senior Planner, AICP	Principal-in-Charge / QA-QC	Senior review; municipal planning; zoning; quality control
Illustrative Engagement Lead	Community Engagement	Engagement design; facilitation; outreach; survey/interview synthesis
Illustrative GIS / Data Analyst	GIS & Research	Spatial, demographic and parcel analysis; mapping
Illustrative Transportation Planner, P.E.	Transportation Subconsultant	Complete Streets; safety; transit; connectivity
Illustrative Urban Designer	Urban Design	Concept plans, sections, streetscape and redevelopment visualization

The team structure is illustrative for this portfolio exercise and demonstrates how a proposal coordinator would organize a multidisciplinary municipal planning response.

8. Project Manager Resume - Rachel S. Bailey, M.U.P.

Urban planning, affordable housing, community development, program management, proposal development, technical writing, data analysis and public presentation experience. Graduate planning education is paired with hands-on affordable housing development, construction/project management, grant compliance and community-based housing work.

Education & Training

- M.U.P., University at Buffalo - Neighborhood & Community Development, 2021
- B.A., Economics; A.A.S., Architecture
- Relevant coursework: Housing & Community Development; Land Use; Environmental Planning & Policy; Environmental Economics; Urban Design; Transportation; Economic Development; Planning Methods; GIS; Nonprofit Management; Land Use Law
- Additional training: construction finance, financial modeling, affordable housing compliance and LIHTC/multifamily housing finance

Selected Experience

- Family Services Manager - community-based program administration, staff supervision, service coordination, procedures and data tracking.
- Homeless Outreach / Emergency Family Shelter Program Manager - program analytics, HMIS, coordinated entry, public-agency coordination, compliance, billing, staff supervision and crisis response.
- Housing Development Manager / Project Manager - affordable single-family development exceeding $2 million, HUD-funded activities, construction budgets, contractor coordination, M/WBE compliance, closings and delivery.
- Marketing / proposal / procurement experience - RFP development, proposal coordination, marketing collateral, technical writing, presentations, purchasing and cross-functional coordination.

9. Relevant Experience

Project	Relevance	Selected Scope / Outcome
Homelessness in Rochester and Beyond	Housing & community development research	Research and 90-minute professional planning presentation examining causes, barriers, solutions and planning implications.
Northeast Greenway / Rail-to-Trail Studio	Transportation, land use & environmental planning	Corridor planning, rail-to-trail activation, connectivity, community context, environmental considerations and implementation concepts.
Buffalo Innovation District Feasibility	Economic development & urban planning	Planning report evaluating innovation-district conditions, market/land-use factors, institutional assets and place-based strategies.
Rochester 2034 Comprehensive Plan Review	Comprehensive planning / policy analysis	Plan review, policy communication, implementation themes and community development considerations.
Affordable Housing Development Applications	Housing finance & development	Mock LIHTC feasibility, budgets, sources/uses, eligible basis, equity, debt sizing and QAP scoring.

10. Cost Proposal

Task	Professional Labor	Subconsultants / Direct	Task Total
1. Project Initiation & Management	$26,000	$2,500	$28,500
2. Existing Conditions, GIS & Field Analysis	$39,000	$8,500	$47,500
3. Community & Stakeholder Engagement	$37,500	$9,000	$46,500
4. Market, Housing & Development Analysis	$32,000	$7,000	$39,000
5. Transportation, Mobility & Connectivity	$25,000	$8,500	$33,500
6. Vision, Urban Design & Revitalization Framework	$31,500	$9,000	$40,500

10. Cost Proposal - Continued

Task	Professional Labor	Subconsultants / Direct	Task Total
7. Zoning & Land Use Recommendations	$22,000	$2,500	$24,500
8. Implementation, Funding & Grant Readiness	$27,000	$4,500	$31,500
9. Draft Plan, Adoption Support & Final Deliverables	$20,000	$2,500	$22,500
Direct / reimbursable expenses	-	$5,400	$5,400
TOTAL NOT-TO-EXCEED	**$260,000**	**$59,400**	**$319,400**

The $319,400 total not-to-exceed fee remains within the City's $325,000 maximum and covers the 16-month work program, engagement, GIS/field analysis, catalyst-site visualization, transportation and zoning analysis, implementation/funding strategy and adoption support.

11. Compliance Matrix

RFP Requirement	Proposal Location	Status
Cover letter	Front matter	Complete
Executive summary	Section 1	Complete
Project understanding	Section 2	Complete
All nine technical tasks	Section 3	Complete
Community engagement	Section 4	Complete
Visual/catalyst concepts	Section 5	Value-added
16-month schedule	Section 6	Complete
Team / organization	Section 7	Complete
Resume	Section 8	Complete
Relevant experience	Section 9	Complete
Cost proposal	Section 10	Complete - $319,400
Forms A-I	Separate City forms	Not fabricated in portfolio sample

Implementation Snapshot

Priority Action	Lead / Partners	Timing	Potential Funding
South Gateway mixed-use catalyst predevelopment	City + development partner	0-2 yrs	CDBG/HOME; housing; private
Riverside trail and access design	City + transportation/parks	0-2 yrs	Transportation; parks; resilience
Complete Streets priority corridor	City / DOT / transit	1-4 yrs	Federal/state transportation; capital
Adaptive reuse feasibility / brownfield work	City + property/development partners	0-3 yrs	Brownfield; economic development; historic
Zoning text/map amendments	City	0-2 yrs	Local budget / planning grants